When I started working as a ServiceNow support engineer, I believed success meant closing as many tickets as possible. On average, we handled 10 to 15 support tickets every day, and initially, I focused only on completing them quickly. However, after a few months, I noticed that 3 to 4 tickets every day were repeat issues, where different users reported the same problem again and again. This made me realise that we were solving the immediate issue, but not the root cause. When I calculated the numbers, I found that 4 repeat tickets a day meant nearly 80 repeat tickets every month. The tricky part was that our dashboard showed a high number of closed tickets, making our performance look excellent. But it didn't reveal how much time was being spent on recurring problems. If each ticket took around 15 minutes to resolve, those repeat issues alone consumed nearly 20 hours every month. That was when I understood the power of storytelling with data. Instead of saying, "we have many repeat tickets", I could say, "we spent almost three working days every month solving the same problems." That single insight completely changed my perspective. I started asking not just, how can I close this ticket faster, but also, why is this issue happening repeatedly? And how can I prevent it?

Imagine if we reduced repeat tickets from 4 per day to just 1 per day. We could save around 60 tickets and nearly 15 hours of work every month. Those hours could be invested in improving processes, automating repetitive task, or providing better support to users. This experience taught me that data alone is just numbers. But when you connect those numbers to real problem and a meaningful solution, they become a story that drives better decision.